Figure 8 — The transfer ladder

A rule that clears the matched gate does not clear it on the live engine. Gate: local acc ≥ 0.65 AND gap LCB > 0.5 — both, which is why both axes are drawn.

Rung 1 — matched dense-LIF forward, n = 20

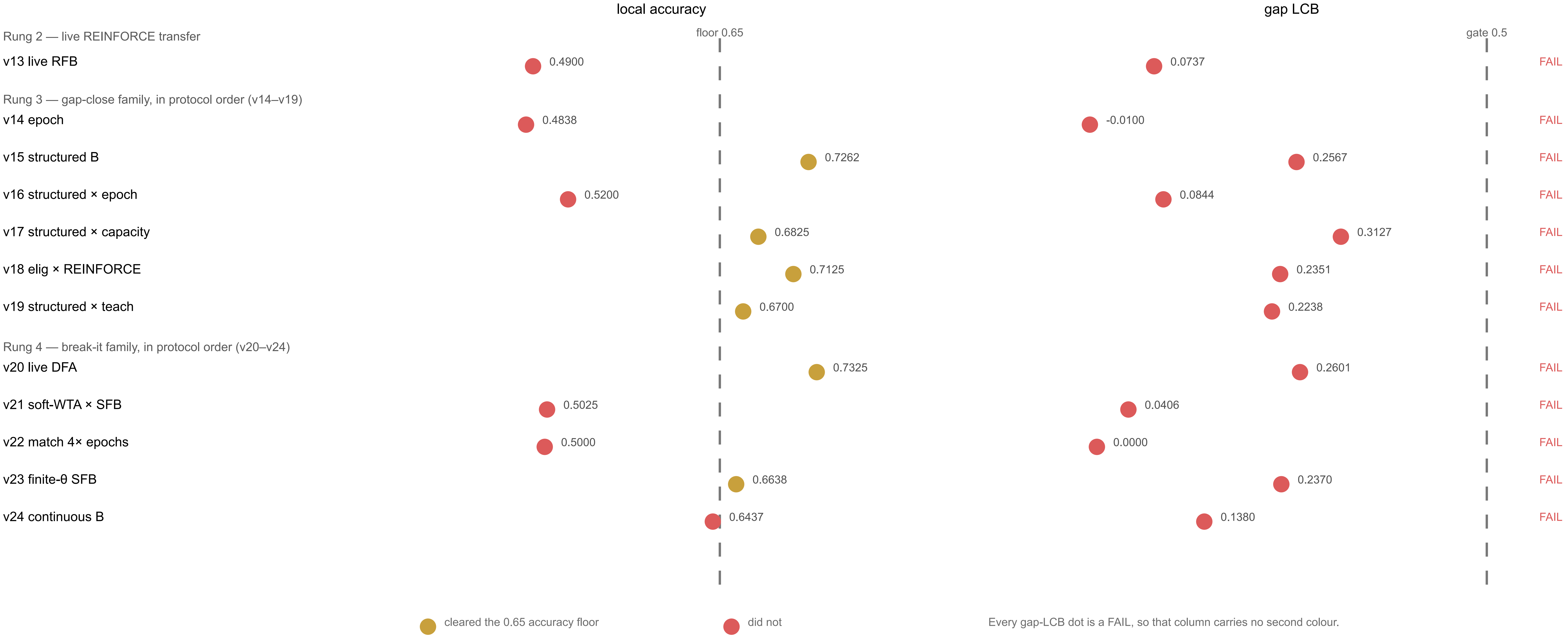
PASS matched REINFORCE × frozen B_i (v12)

gap LCB 0.9765 ff / 0.9079 rec — clears both halves of the gate on both forward graphs

0.9950 ff / 0.9812 rec

THE SUBSTRATE CHANGES HERE. Everything below runs on the live event-driven muted-θ / k-WTA engine, not on the matched dense-LIF forward above.

This ladder is NOT one system at twelve settings, and nothing is drawn across the break. Rungs 2-4 are unaffected by the 2026-08-25 matched re-run: none of them runs on that forward.



EVERY ARM BELOW THE BREAK FAILS THE GATE. 6 of 12 clear the 0.65 accuracy floor; the best gap LCB anywhere below rung 1 is v17's 0.3127, against a bar of 0.5.

Floor cleared is not gate cleared, and the two axes exist so that cannot be read off one. The best local below the break is v15's 0.7262 — on accuracy alone it looks like a near miss.

NOT A RANKING. v14–v24 are a SEQUENTIAL EXPLORATORY family: each new hypothesis minted a new protocol version and hash, and there is no multiplicity-corrected family-wise claim over them.

v15 and v17 are named as landmarks because the specification names them, not as winners. Rows are in protocol order and are never sorted by either quantity.

NO MECHANISM. Four suspects for the transfer gap — sticky last_spike, partial membrane reset, θ=∞ muting, hard k-WTA — have never been tested individually, and this figure does not attribute the gap to any of them.